Strictly Private and Confidential

7th April 2025

Qamar Shahzad Malik
Flat 12 Grosvenor Court
Brewster Road
Leyton
E106RH

CONTRACT OF EMPLOYMENT

Dear **Qamar**,

This is your Contract of Employment and contains a statement of the applicable terms and conditions of your employment as required by section 1 of the Employment Rights Act 1996.

1. Commencement And Duration Of Employment

1.1. Your employer is **VF Services (UK) Limited** (the Company or We). Your employment with the Company will commence on **14th April 2025** and shall continue subject to the remaining terms and conditions of this agreement, until it terminates on **13th October 2025**, without the need for notice, unless previously terminated by either party giving the other not less than one month in writing. No employment with a previous employer counts towards your period of continuous employment with the Company.

1.2. The first **three** months of your employment shall be a probationary period and your employment may be terminated during this period at any time on two weeks' prior notice. We may, at our discretion, extend this period for up to a further **three** months. During this probationary period your performance and suitability for continued employment will be monitored. At the end of your probationary period you will be informed in writing if you have successfully completed your probationary period.

2. Job Title

2.1. You are employed as **Officer - Operations at Professional Level P5**, in which capacity you shall devote all your time, attention and skill to your duties of employment. You shall report directly to **Deputy Manager - Operations** or to any Manager as required.

Your role and responsibilities shall include, but shall not be limited to:

- Processing applications and data entry
- Collection and scrutiny of passports from the Application Centre
- Handover of Passports to the Embassy and/or its Consulates

- Handover of passports to Courier/Applicants
- Handling of postal applications
- Tracking of passports
- Handling customer queries in person, by email and on the telephone
- Fee collection and cash handling
- Preparing reports for day to day transactions
- General administration duties

Please note, the above list is by no means exhaustive and definitive, it could well be subject to change, expansion and contraction as the Company progresses. You may be required to undertake other duties from time to time as the Company may reasonably require.

2.2. You warrant that you are entitled to work in the UK without any additional approvals or impediments and will notify the Company immediately if you cease to be so entitled at any time during your employment with the Company.

2.3. You shall not work for anyone else while you are employed by the Company within your contracted hours. Any other work must be declared on the Possible Conflict of Interest form.

3. Place of Work

3.1. Your normal place of work will be VF Services (UK) Ltd**, 66 Wilson Street, EC2A 2BT, London, United Kingdom.** In order to fulfil the duties of your employment, on occasion, you may be required to travel and to work at an alternative location within the Company.

3.2. You will not be required to work outside the UK for any continuous period of more than three months during the term of your employment. Recognising the need for flexibility in your role, and you agree to travel on the Company's business (both within the United Kingdom or abroad) as may be required for the proper performance of your duties at all times.

4. Salary

4.1. Your basic salary is **GBP 29,750 per annum**, which shall accrue from day to day and be payable monthly in arrears on or before the last working day of each month directly into your bank or building society account.

4.2. Although the Company will review your basic salary annually, there is no obligation on the Company to award an increase in any year. There will be no review of salary after notice has been given by either party to terminate your employment.

4.3. We shall be entitled to deduct from your salary or other payments due to you, any money which you may owe to the Company at any time. By signing this contract, you authorise the Company to make such deductions when required.

4.4. Where a shortage or deficiency is found in money or stock for which you are responsible, we shall be entitled to recover an amount equal to the full amount or value of the shortage or stock deficiency from the salary due to you under this Contract.

5. Hours of Work and Rules

5.1. Your normal hours of work will be any 5 days between **Monday to Saturday, 8:00 am to 7:00 pm daily.** A normal working day will be **8 hours and 15 minutes.** This equates to a working week of **41 hours and 15 minutes.**

5.2. In addition to your working day, you are entitled to a lunch break of 45 minutes (unpaid). Time of breaks should be agreed with the reporting manager to suit the requirements of the Department. If working less than 6 hours or equal to 6 hours per day you are not entitled to a break.

5.3. You would be eligible for overtime as per the Company policy for any additional hours worked over and above the contracted hours. You should seek approval from your reporting manager before doing any overtime. Any overtime hours should be approved by your reporting manager otherwise they will be unpaid.

5.4. You are required at all times to comply with our rules, policies and procedures in force from time to time including those contained in the Employee Handbook and on MySpace. The Employee Handbook does not form part of this agreement and the Company may amend it at any time.

6. Lay-off and short-time working

6.1. If there is a reduced need for employees to perform work of a particular kind on a temporary or permanent basis, or any other occurrence which affects normal working, we shall be entitled to lay you off or impose short-time working for such period as we shall decide.

6.2. While you are laid off you shall not be required to work and shall have no right to remuneration [subject to Clause 6.5].

6.3. While you are on short-time working your working hours may be reduced as we see fit and your remuneration shall be correspondingly reduced [subject to Clause 6.5].

6.4. We shall as much notice as is reasonably practicable of lay-off or short-time working. Thereafter we shall give as much notice as is reasonably practicable of any further change to your hours including a return to normal working hours.

6.5. During any period of lay-off or short-time working we shall pay statutory guarantee pay in accordance with legislation in force from time to time.

7. Holidays

7.1. You are entitled to 32 days paid holiday during each holiday year. This includes the usual public holidays in England and Wales / Scotland / Northern Ireland or a day in lieu where the Company requires you to work on a public holiday. The Company's holiday year runs between 1 January and 31 December. If your employment commences or finishes part way through the holiday year, your holiday entitlement during that year shall be calculated on a pro-rata basis rounded up to the nearest half day.

7.2. You shall give at least 4 weeks' notice of any proposed holiday dates and these must be agreed by your reporting manager in writing in advance. You should apply for your holidays through the online system. No more than ten days holiday may be taken at any one time unless prior consent is obtained from your reporting manager and HR. We may require you to take (or not take) holiday on specific days as notified to you, including during your notice period.

7.3. You are allowed to carry over annual leaves based on UK employment law and as per VFS UK employee's handbook. In cases of sickness absence, maternity, adoption, and parental leave, carry over is limited to four week's holiday per year less any leave taken during the holiday year that has just ended. Any such carried over holiday which is not taken within twelve months of the end of the relevant holiday year will be lost.

7.4. We shall not pay you in lieu of untaken holiday except on termination of the Appointment. On termination we shall pay you in lieu of any accrued but untaken holiday for the holiday year in which termination takes place and any untaken days permitted to be carried forward from the preceding holiday year. The amount of the payment in lieu will be calculated as 1/260th of your full-time equivalent salary for each untaken day of the entitlement.

7.5. We may require you to take any outstanding holiday entitlement during your notice period (irrespective of whether we or you served notice to terminate your employment).

7.6. If you have taken more holiday than your accrued entitlement at the date of termination of your employment, we shall be entitled to deduct the excess holiday pay from any payments due to you for each excess day.

7.7. If we have terminated or would be entitled to terminate the Appointment under Clause 9 or if you have terminated the Appointment in breach of this agreement any payment due under Clause 7.4 shall be limited to your statutory entitlement under the Working Time Regulations 1998 (SI 1998/1833) and any paid holidays (including paid public holidays) taken shall be deemed first to have been taken in satisfaction of that statutory entitlement.

7.8. During any continuous period of sickness absence of one month or more you shall only accrue statutory holiday under the Working Time Regulations 1998 and not contractual holiday (as set out in clause 7.1).

7.9. If you are ill or injured during a period of pre-arranged annual leave and you have evidence supporting such illness or injury you may ask us to treat the days of incapacity as sickness absence instead of annual leave. You must inform your reporting manager of your incapacity and its likely duration on the first day of your sickness absence and follow our sickness absence policy thereafter even if you are abroad. We may require evidence of your illness or injury from your first day of absence.

7.10. A day's pay for the purposes of this clause 7 shall be 1/260th of your basic annual salary (or full-time equivalent where you work part-time) as referred to in clause 4.1 above.

8. Incapacity

8.1. If you are absent from work due to incapacity, you must notify your reporting manager of the reason for your absence as soon as possible but no later than one hour before your start time on the first day of absence. You should speak with your reporting manager or HR Manager for every day of absence for the first seven calendar days of absence and no less than once a week thereafter.

8.2. In all cases of absence a self-certification form, which is available from your reporting manager, must be completed on your return to work and supplied to HR. For any period of incapacity which lasts for seven consecutive calendar days or more, a doctor's certificate stating the reason for absence must be obtained and supplied to HR or reporting manager at your own cost. Further certificates must be obtained if the absence continues for longer than the period of the original certificate and given to HR in a timely manner.

8.3. You agree to consent to a medical examination (at our expense) by a doctor nominated by the Company should the Company so require. You agree that any report produced in connection with any such examination may be disclosed to the Company and the Company may discuss the contents of the report with the relevant doctor.

8.4. For any period of incapacity, which lasts for seven consecutive calendar days or more, we shall pay you Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) provided that you satisfy the relevant requirements. Your qualifying days for SSP purposes are Monday to Friday.

8.5. For any period of incapacity, you will be entitled up to seven days of company sick pay per year (on a rolling 12 month basis) after you have completed one full year of service. Other payments can include Statutory Sick Pay provided that you satisfy the relevant requirements. Your qualifying days for SSP purposes are Monday to Friday.

8.6. Pension contributions will continue as normal while you are paid at the full rate of pay through Company sick pay in accordance with clause 8.5. When you are in receipt of SSP only, the level of contributions in respect of your membership of the Company's Pension Scheme may continue, subject to the relevant pension scheme rules in force at the time of your absence.

8.7. If a period of absence is or appears to be occasioned by actionable negligence, nuisance or breach of any statutory duty on the part of a third party in respect of which damages are or may be recoverable, you shall immediately notify the Company of that fact and of any claim, settlement or judgment made or awarded in connection with it and all relevant particulars that the Company may reasonably require. You shall if required by the Company, co-operate in any related legal proceedings and refund to the Company that part of any damages or compensation recovered by you relating to the loss of earnings for the period of absence as the Company may reasonably determine less any costs borne by you in connection with the recovery of such damages or compensation, provided that the amount to be refunded shall not exceed the total amount paid to you by the Company in respect of the period of absence.

9. Termination And Notice Period

9.1. It is acknowledged that this agreement is intended to last for a fixed term to expire automatically, without the need of for any previous written notice on **13th October 2025.**

Notwithstanding the foregoing :-
The prior written notice required from you or the Company to terminate your employment shall be as follows:

During the duration of your employment the probationary period will be as stated in paragragh 1.1 and 1.2 form either party.

9.2. We shall be entitled to dismiss you at any time without notice or payment in lieu of notice if you commit a serious breach of your obligations as an employee, or if you cease to be entitled to work in the United Kingdom, or if we receive an unsatisfactory background verification report from our authorised vendor.

9.3. If you fail to successfully complete the mandatory modules of the Company Learning Management System, or if you fail to successfully pass the mandatory Process Training Certification, we hold the right to dismiss you but with payment in lieu of notice.

9.4. Notwithstanding clause 9.1, we may, in our sole and absolute discretion, terminate your employment at any time and with immediate effect by notifying you that we are exercising our right under this Clause 9.4 and that we will make within 28 days the first instalment of a payment in lieu of notice (Payment in Lieu) to you. This Payment in Lieu will be equal to the basic salary (as at the date of termination) which you would have been entitled to receive under this agreement during the notice period referred to at Clause 9.1 (or, if notice has already been given, during the remainder of the notice period) less income tax and National Insurance contributions.

9.4.1 For the avoidance of doubt, the Payment in Lieu shall not include any element in relation to:

a. any bonus or commission payments that might otherwise have been due during the period for which the Payment in Lieu is made;
b. any payment in respect of benefits which you would have been entitled to receive during the period for which the Payment in Lieu is made; and
c. any payment in respect of any holiday entitlement that would have accrued during the period for which the Payment in Lieu is made.

9.4.2 We may pay any sums due under Clause 9.4 in equal monthly instalments until the date on which the notice period referred to at clause 9.1 would have expired if notice had been given. You shall be obliged to seek alternative income during this period and to notify us of any income so received. The instalment payments shall then be reduced by the amount of such income.

9.4.3 You shall have no right to receive a Payment in Lieu unless we have exercised our discretion in Clause 9.4. Nothing in this Clause 9.4 shall prevent us from terminating your employment in breach.

9.4.4 Notwithstanding Clause 9.4 you shall not be entitled to any Payment in Lieu if we would otherwise have been entitled to terminate your employment without notice in accordance with Clause 9.2. In that case we shall also be entitled to recover from you any Payment in Lieu (or instalments thereof) already made.

9.5. The Company reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to require employees who have resigned with notice, or who have been given notice to terminate their contract by the Company, not to attend their place of work for all or part of the notice period and to remain on garden leave during any such period.

9.6. If you are placed on garden leave, you will not be allowed to come to work, meaning that you must stay away from the workplace during the garden-leave period unless called by the senior management. If you are placed on garden leave, the Company reserves the right to:

- confiscate any equipment belonging to the Company that you may have, typically a laptop, at the start of the garden-leave period;
- require you to carry out alternative duties or to only perform such specific duties as are expressly assigned to you, at such location (including your home) as the Company may decide;
- require you not to have any contact with any officer, employee, consultant, client, customer, supplier, agent, adviser or other business contact for work-related purposes during the garden-leave period (unless otherwise permitted); and
- prevent you from having any contact with another organisation, typically a competitor, during the garden-leave period.

If you are placed on garden leave, your contract of employment will continue in force until the end of the notice period. This means that, during the garden-leave period, you will:

- continue to receive full pay and benefits (with the exception of benefits that are given to allow you to do your job, such as a work mobile phone or company car) in the normal way;
- remain bound by all the obligations and restrictions set out in your contract of employment, including any confidentiality clauses and restrictive covenants contained in your contract of employment, save the duty to attend your place of work;
- not be permitted to take up other employment during the garden-leave period; and
- be required to remain available to be contacted by the Company and may be varied at any time to meet Company requirements.

10. Disciplinary And Grievance Procedures

10.1. Your attention is drawn to the disciplinary and grievance procedures applicable to your employment, which are contained in the Employee Handbook. These procedures do not form part of your contract of employment.

10.2. If you wish to appeal against a disciplinary decision you may apply in writing to the HR Manager in accordance with our disciplinary procedure.

10.3. We reserve the right to suspend you with pay for a period of no longer than is necessary for the purposes of investigating any allegation of misconduct against you or so long as is otherwise reasonable while any formal procedure against you is outstanding.

10.4. If you wish to raise a grievance you may apply in writing to either your reporting manager or the HR Manager, in accordance with our grievance procedure.

11. Pensions

11.1 If eligible, the Company will auto-enrol you into a pension scheme, in accordance with its pension's auto-enrolment obligations. The Company reserves the right of a three-month postponement after which time it will automatically enrol you unless you otherwise opt out. Full details of the scheme will be given to you when you are enrolled, including the minimum level of contributions that you will be required to make during your membership and your right to opt out if you do not want to be a member of the scheme.

While participating in the scheme, you agree to worker pension contributions being deducted from your salary. Membership of the scheme is subject to its rules as may be amended from time to time, and the organisation may replace the scheme with another pension scheme at any time. If you cease to be a member of the scheme for any reason, the organisation will re-enrol you automatically into a pension scheme as and when required by law.

Further details about the scheme can be obtained from the HR department.

12. Collective Agreement

There is no collective agreement, which directly affects your employment.

13. Changes To Your Terms Of Employment

We reserve the right to make reasonable changes to any of your terms of employment where business need requires it. You will be notified in writing of any change as soon as possible and in any event within one month of the change.

14. Confidential Information

14.1. You shall not use or disclose to any person either during or at any time after your employment with the Company any confidential information about the business or affairs of the Company or any of its business contacts, or about any other matters which may come to your knowledge in the course of your employment. For the purposes of this clause 14, **confidential information** means any information or matter which is not in the public domain (except as a result of your breach of this agreement) and which relates to the affairs of the Company or any of its business contacts

14.2. The restriction in clause 14.1 does not apply to:

a) Prevent you from making a protected disclosure within the meaning of section 43A of the Employment Rights Act 1996; or

a) Use or disclosure that has been authorised by the Company is required by law or by your employment.

b) Any protected disclosures made under VFS Global's Whistleblowing Policy.

15. Company Property

15.1. All documents, manuals, hardware and software provided for your use by the Company, and any data or documents (including copies) produced, maintained or stored on the Company's computer systems or other electronic equipment (including mobile phones), remain the property of the Company.

15.2. Any Company property in your possession and any original or copy documents obtained by you in the course of your employment shall be returned to your reporting manager at any time on request and in any event prior to the termination of your employment with the Company.

16. Third Party Rights

The Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 shall not apply to this agreement. No person other than you and the Company shall have any rights under this agreement and this agreement shall not be enforceable by any person other than you and the Company.

17. Employee's Personal Data

17.1. The Company will collect and process information relating to you in accordance with the privacy notice which is on the intranet OR annexed to this Agreement. You are required to sign and date the privacy notice, and return to HR or your reporting manager to confirm your understanding of our commitment to fair processing of personnel data.

17.2. You confirm that you have read and understood the Company's Data Protection Policy, a copy of which is attached and contained in the employee handbook. You confirm that you will comply with the Data Protection Policy when handling personal data in the course of your employment including personal data relating to any employee, worker, contractor, customer, client, supplier or agent of the Company and any Group Company. You will also comply with the Company's IT and communications systems policy, Social media policy, Bring your own device to work (BYOD) policy, Any Other Policy.

17.3. Failure to comply with the Data Protection Policy or any of the policies listed above in Clause 17.2 may be dealt with under the Company's disciplinary procedure and, in serious cases, may be treated as gross misconduct leading to summary dismissal.

18. General

18.1. This agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties and supersedes and extinguishes all previous agreements, promises, assurances, warranties, representations and understandings between them, whether written or oral, relating to its subject matter.

18.2. Each party acknowledges that in entering into this agreement it does not rely on, and shall have no remedies in respect of, any statement, representation, assurance or warranty (whether made innocently or negligently) that is not set out in this agreement.

18.3. Each party agrees that it shall have no claim for innocent or negligent misrepresentation or negligent misstatement based on any statement in this agreement.

18.4. Nothing in this clause shall limit or exclude any liability for fraud.

18.5. No variation or agreed termination of this agreement shall be effective unless it is in writing and signed by the parties (or their authorised representatives).

18.6. This agreement and any dispute or claim arising out of or in connection with it or its subject matter or formation (including non-contractual disputes or claims) shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the law of England and Wales.

18.7. Each party irrevocably agrees that the courts of England and Wales shall have exclusive jurisdiction to settle any dispute or claim arising out of or in connection with this agreement or its subject matter or formation (including non-contractual disputes or claims).

We look forward to your acceptance of this offer and to our mutual success.

Yours Sincerely,

For **VF Services (UK) Limited**

Giuliana La Grasta
Regional HR Head – Europe

For **VF Services (UK) Limited**

Elizabeth Samuel
Deputy Regional Head - Europe

I agree to the above terms and conditions.

_____	_____	_____
Qamar Shahzad Malik	**Employee Signature**	**Date**